

● RECOMMENDATION • PAYMENTS

ONE COUNTER. ONE WEBSITE. ONE SYSTEM.

The short version: NWD's payment setup has been moved three times in four months — off CardPointe, onto Echelon's HYFIN page, then onto iPOSays, the last time without notice. The online bill-pay link on nwtees.com simply died until someone caught it, and every fix runs through a support case and somebody else's schedule. That isn't bad luck — it's the structure: the card reader and the online payments are separate products stitched together by a reseller chain, and when any layer changes, the shop is the last to know.

A modern provider replaces that chain with **one account that runs both sides of the business** — the terminal at the counter, plus invoices, payment links, and the bill-pay page online — in one dashboard NWD controls directly.

THE PICK: SQUARE

2.6% + 15¢

IN PERSON, AT THE
COUNTER

3.3% + 30¢

ONLINE & INVOICES

\$0

MONTHLY FEE

\$299

TERMINAL, ONE-TIME

- **Everything in one place.** Counter sales, emailed invoices with a built-in Pay button, and a permanent payment link for the website.
- **The website link never breaks again.** The pay page belongs to NWD's own account — there is no back-end gateway swap that can kill it.
- **Self-serve settings.** Change a timer, a price, or a receipt from a phone. No case numbers, no walk-throughs.
- **No contract.** Next-business-day deposits, cancel anytime, hardware is a one-time purchase.

THE HONEST TRADE-OFF — AND THE ALTERNATIVE

Square's flat rate may run slightly above a negotiated merchant-account rate on some cards. What it buys is no middlemen, no surprise migrations, and software the shop runs itself. If shaving fees matters more than polish, **Helcim** (\$0/month, interchange-plus — roughly 0.4% + 8¢ over cost in person) is the budget pick: same one-account model, fewer hardware options, two-day deposits.

WHAT SWITCHING TAKES

Sign-up takes about 15 minutes, the terminal ships in days, and the website update is a same-day change. Run Square alongside the current setup until the first deposits clear, and check the Echelon paperwork for termination terms before closing the old account. **Nothing about this switch takes the shop offline.**